

atmosphere and have a unique window into the lives of our children. This past summer, Savannah was home and had a friend from New York University visiting for a few days. After lunch, we had a couple of drinks and started talking about dating. “Here’s what I think,” I said, and proceeded to share my views. Because we’d been using Sunday dinner as a forum for opinions for years, I wasn’t summarily ignored! Quite the opposite, in fact. We all had a great conversation that would never have happened if we hadn’t been in such an informal environment.

Just last weekend, the four of us were up at our cottage in Muskoka. Linda and I were enjoying the peace and quiet, but it took all of 10 minutes for the kids to admit they’d rather have their friends with them. That weekend, we started as four and eventually became 20. We had kids from as close as Toronto to as far as New York enjoying the weekend away. Everybody wanted to be a part of it, and it was a great time for all involved. Linda and I got to talk to our children’s friends, to have conversations we wouldn’t have had any other way.

